

Strategic Sales Structure and Scoping Frameworks: An Educational Guide

This document provides a comprehensive breakdown of the strategic sales and scoping templates designed to help advisors systematically manage client engagements. By aligning advisor experience with client complexity, these frameworks facilitate a structured, low-pressure environment that benefits both the advisor and the business owner.

Section 1: Detailed Breakdown of Core Templates

1. The Introduction Prompts

- **Core Benefits:** Provides a scripted, logical progression for the crucial first meeting, moving smoothly from building rapport ("Foreplay") to setting clear expectations. It uses an "Event, Cause & Effect" storytelling model to build credibility and establish empathy without feeling interrogative.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** It structures the conversation so the advisor maintains control. By using "Check Time" and "Ask Permission" scripts, the advisor can naturally transition into business talk while ensuring they have the floor to explain their approach uninterrupted.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** It reduces anxiety by explicitly defining the meeting objective and making the decision-making process visible. The owner knows exactly what will happen next, which removes the tension of a high-pressure sales pitch.
- **Suitable for:** Initial discovery sessions and early-stage prospect meetings where trust foundations and mutual alignment need to be established.

2. The Lite Sales Prompts

- **Core Benefits:** This template uses a specific, modular "Campaign" approach built around a structured sequence using the acronym **S.P.I.D.E.R: Show** your get out of jail card, **Pin** the tail on the donkey (Growth Curve), **Investigate** blockages, **Determine/Dangle** the prize (Revenue Model), **Ensure** conditions are agreed, and **Reveal** the golden key.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** It simplifies the sales process into manageable steps and introduces predefined boundaries (e.g., requiring the client to commit time, take action, and agree to a monthly fee) before the final solution is revealed.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** It provides visual context for their business struggles by placing them on a "Growth Curve" and clearly outlines the financial potential of fixing their constraints through the "Revenue Model".
- **Suitable for:** Smaller, less complex business circumstances where the advisor is offering a pre-packaged program (Modular Delivery) typically requiring 1-2 hours to complete the sale.

3. The Scoping Prompts

- **Core Benefits:** This template establishes the framework for a deep-dive, fact-finding mission that explores the internal drivers of the business without the immediate pressure of proposing solutions.

- **How it helps the Advisor:** It explicitly separates the "discovery" phase from the "solution" phase. It also provides a structured way to give a rough price estimate ("between \$x and \$y") to qualify the prospect's budget early on without committing to a hard quote.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** It reassures the client through privacy statements and establishes that the session is about challenging their thinking and understanding their unique issues, not just filling out a survey.
- **Suitable for:** Complex engagements or bespoke "Total Needs" selling, where understanding the specific nuances of the client's operations is mandatory before presenting a proposal.

4. The Presentation Prompts

- **Core Benefits:** Focuses on the "Reveal" stage, giving advisors a structured method to present their service offer while systematically neutralizing objections.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** It utilizes the strategy of "Calling out the ghosts" by proactively identifying and parking potential concerns (like price or delivery issues) before they disrupt the presentation. It also guides the advisor to use "Trial Closing" to test the prospect's receptiveness throughout the meeting.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** The transparent approach reduces the emotional charge of negotiations. By agreeing that neither party has to commit to an unworkable deal, the client feels respected and safe to voice their true thoughts.
- **Suitable for:** The pivotal meeting where the tailored solution or formal proposal is presented, leading up to the final implementation decision.

5. The Implementation Rationale

- **Core Benefits:** Designed to manage the final negotiation stages, focusing heavily on bridging the "Emotional Intensity Gap"—the difference between expectations and reality.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** It trains the advisor to establish firm negotiation boundaries by differentiating between "must have" and "nice to have" terms (e.g., must have \$10,000, like to have it paid upfront). It encourages detachment from the outcome so the advisor remains objective.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** By handling objections as legitimate feedback rather than arguments to be won, the client is invited to co-solve problems. This ensures they aren't pressured into a "shoe-horned" deal.
- **Suitable for:** Final-stage closing meetings where the goal is to finalize contracts, define boundaries, and handle any lingering objections to secure a win-win agreement.

6. The Decision Tree & Sales Structure

- **Core Benefits:** This acts as the strategic brain behind the operation, providing a flowchart to determine the best sales approach (Modular/Campaign vs. Bespoke/Total Needs) based on the client's sophistication and the advisor's confidence.

- **How it helps the Advisor:** It removes the guesswork. If an advisor is new, the tree directs them to "Free Client Content" for a softer experience. If dealing with a targeted prospect who fits a smaller business profile, it routes them to the "Lite Fundamentals" process.
 - **How it helps the Business Owner:** It ensures the sales approach aligns with their specific processing style—whether they are an Activist who wants quick action, a Pragmatist seeking proof, a Reflector needing time, or a Theorist wanting to contribute.
 - **Suitable for:** Advisors in the planning phase, deciding how to categorize leads and which presentation/scoping pathway will yield the highest success rate.
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Section 2: Step-by-Step Practical Application

Here is a practical method for deploying this material with a new prospect:

- **Step 1: Preparation & Triage (Using the Decision Tree).** Before contacting the prospect, use the Decision Tree to evaluate their business profile. Decide if you are launching a pre-packaged "Campaign" (for smaller, lower-fee clients) or a bespoke "Total Needs" process (for larger, complex clients). Identify the prospect's likely learning style to tailor your communication.
- **Step 2: The Introduction Meeting.** Open the meeting using the "Foreplay" script to build rapport, then "Check Time" to establish a professional boundary. State your meeting objective clearly, share a relevant "Common Problem" story to build empathy, and confirm if they are open to a more detailed scoping session.
- **Step 3: Scoping or Lite Sales.**
 - *If using the Lite Sales Track (Campaign):* Follow the SPIDER acronym. Show your "get out of jail card," map their position on the Growth Curve, investigate their constraints, dangle the Revenue Model, set your three conditions for working together, and reveal the program.
 - *If using Bespoke Scoping:* Schedule 1.5 hours. Establish that you are there to challenge their thinking, not provide immediate solutions. Guide them through the fact-find and provide a rough budget estimate at the end.
- **Step 4: The Presentation.** When returning with a proposal, set the scene by confirming nothing has changed in their business since you last spoke. Immediately "Call out the ghosts" to neutralize known objections. Use trial closing ("How does this look/feel/sound?") as you reveal the offer.
- **Step 5: Implementation & Negotiation.** Enter the final meeting knowing your "must have" boundaries. If caught with an unexpected objection, recognize its importance objectively ("On a scale of 1-10, how critical is this issue?") and invite the client to help solve the difference rather than defending your position.

Section 3: Common Q&A

1. What is the difference between "Campaign Selling" and "Total Needs Selling"?

Campaign selling involves approaching clients with a pre-packaged, modular solution to a common issue, making it faster to deliver but with a risk of missing nuanced problems. Total Needs selling is an explorative, bespoke process void of solution bias, which takes more time and confidence but addresses complex problems and yields larger fees.

2. Where should a new or less confident advisor start in this framework?

New advisors should start with the "Free Client Content" section. This provides a softer experience because it does not end with a specific offer, removing the feeling of being pressured or "channelled" and setting the stage for future discussions.

3. How should I handle a client who constantly brings up objections during the final presentation?

The most effective strategy is to proactively "Call out the ghosts" by naming the likely objections at the beginning of the presentation to remove the emotional tension. If an unexpected objection arises, clarify its importance, state your reply without judgment, and ask the client how they believe both parties could "get around this issue".

4. How do I adapt my sales approach to different client personalities?

You should design a sales process that considers the four Processing Styles (Honey & Mumford). For instance, give *Reflectors* the time they need to withdraw and think, provide *Pragmatists* with proof and data, explain the sequence of action to impulsive *Activists*, and allow *Theorists* to voice their ideas on the solution.

5. Why is the "Emotional Intensity Gap" important during negotiations?

Emotions are driven by our expectations and the variation between those expectations and reality. Managing client expectations proactively ensures that you facilitate a logical win-win agreement rather than dealing with the negative experience of a mismatched reality.

6. What should I do if a prospect simply isn't a good fit or we can't agree on terms?

You must mentally define your "walk away price" and negotiation boundaries beforehand. Maintain your perspective and emotional detachment; it is perfectly acceptable to decline unprofitable business. You should excuse yourself tactfully, leaving the door open to check back in 6 to 12 months.

Section 4: Source Summary Table

Template Name	Core Focus & Contents
8 Pathways	Maps out various advisor approaches (e.g., Free Client Content, Lite Fundamentals, Specialist Tools) based on the advisor's confidence and the client's complexity.
Get. Sales Structure	Outlines psychological selling fundamentals, including stages of consumer awareness, processing styles, buying motives, and engagement types (Advice, Facilitation, Education).
Get.Decision Tree	A flowchart guiding the choice between Modular/Campaign selling and Bespoke/Total Needs selling. Includes pros, cons, logical decision points, and toolbox suitability for business life cycles.
Get.Implementation Rationale	Focuses on closing deals and managing expectations. Details negotiation boundaries ('must have' vs 'nice to have'), handling objections, and navigating different negotiator styles.
Get.Introduction Prompts	Scripts for conducting first meetings. Covers establishing rapport (Foreplay), setting objectives, building credibility through storytelling, and agreeing on the next steps.
Get.Lite Sales Prompts	A 6-step "Campaign" sales track (SPIDER acronym) focusing on demonstrating business constraints, revealing revenue potential, setting client engagement conditions, and offering a modular growth program.

Get.Presentation Prompts	Guides the advisor through presenting a proposal. Emphasizes setting the scene, preemptively calling out objections ("ghosts"), and using trial closing to secure the next step.
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Get.Scoping Prompts	A framework for deep-dive discovery sessions. Outlines how to allocate time, challenge client thinking safely, ensure confidentiality, and provide early, non-binding price estimates.
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